



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Academy of Excellence: East Tucson

School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/arizona/east-tucson-k-8/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Leman Academy East Tucson presents as a tuition-free K–8 charter school that explicitly markets a classical approach to education and emphasizes character formation, virtue, and wisdom. Public-facing materials describe a “classical education” that aims to build a foundation of wisdom and virtue, with a focus on a close-knit community, personalized learning, and enrichment experiences in the arts and athletics. The site also highlights strong partnerships with families and an active, parent-inclusive culture. Taken together with the school’s explicit emphasis on virtue, character formation, and a rigorous classical framework, the school aligns most clearly with classical aims in several domains, while some elements (notably explicit mention of theology, liturgical practices, or the full traditional Great Books/grammar–logic–rhetoric curriculum) are less obviously documented on the public-facing pages.

Executive classification by category (based on the Classical School rubric and keyword indicators):

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

Important note on evidence: The public materials consistently reference classical education, virtue, wisdom, and character formation, and they emphasize a partnership with families and a supportive faculty. Direct references to theology, liturgical practice, and explicit Great Books/grammar–logic–rhetoric language are limited or not overt in the public pages we can access, which informs category-level judgments in several places. Citations to supporting passages drawn from the school’s public materials are provided inline below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize virtue and wisdom as foundational aims of education. A representative passage describes Leman East Tucson as offering a “classical education that builds a foundation of wisdom and virtue” (public-facing East Tucson page). This expresses a transcendent aspiration toward virtue and wisdom, even if explicit theological or liturgical elements are not stated in the same public-facing text. See description: “offers a K-8 tuition-free classical education that builds a foundation of wisdom and virtue that will take your child far in school and life.”
- The page also frames education as formation of character, e.g., “foundation of wisdom and virtue” and language around forming students as whole persons.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: wisdom, virtue. These map to Element 1’s positive indicators (truth/Goodness/Beauty, virtue, wisdom, transcendentals, imago Dei, etc.). The lexicon lists wisdom and virtue as positive indicators for Relational Meta Foundations.

- Negative keywords present: none identified in the public text (no explicit relativism, secular-humanist framing, or moral-neutral language observed in the accessible excerpts).
- Why this rating
- The school foregrounds virtue and wisdom, signaling a transcendent orientation to moral formation. However, explicit Grounding in Theology, Liturgical/Communal Practices, or a stated transcendental moral realism is not clearly documented in the accessible public materials. Thus, Element 1 is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL, given the partial alignment with the category's aims and the absence of explicit theological or liturgical framing in the public content. See evidence above and rubric expectations from the classical lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The East Tucson materials describe a mission anchored in virtue and wisdom, i.e., formation of character as a primary aim, not mere information transfer. Language such as “a foundation of wisdom and virtue” and “classical education” signals formation of humanity and human excellence, aligning with the classical aim of education as formation (paideia) and telos beyond mere job preparation.
- The materials emphasize a sense of community, partnership with families, and an emphasis on virtues—consistent with the classical telos of forming virtuous, wise individuals. Text references to “foundation of wisdom and virtue” and “character” suggest a formation-oriented purpose rather than purely informational goals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical, lifelong learning, moral imagination, character formation. These are aligned with Element 2's positive indicators (formation of virtue and wisdom, telos, classical mission).
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public text (no overt emphasis on workforce training or 21st-century skills in the accessible excerpts).
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aims center on formation and virtue, bastions of truth, goodness, and beauty as real ceilings for education, and a classical mission—consistent with CLASSICAL for this category. The explicit emphasis on formation over information and the classical telos is evident in public materials. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site consistently labels the program as “classical education” and references a K–8 classical model, with emphasis on enrichment in arts and athletics. This signals a classical curricular orientation, albeit without explicit enumeration of the three liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or a precise Great Books emphasis in the public excerpts we can quote. The public text does not clearly enumerate Great Books lists, Latin/Greek, or the Trivium/Quadrivium in the accessible passages, though it points to a classical framework and a strong emphasis on character formation and classic pedagogy.
- The site's footer and navigation point readers toward a “Curriculum” section and an “Our Approach,” suggesting a dedicated classical curriculum, potentially including Great Books, but explicit specifics are not in the accessible excerpts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: classical, curriculum, Great Books (not explicitly present in the accessible excerpts), liberal arts vocabulary (not all explicitly enumerated in the public text). The strongest signal is the label “classical education,” which maps to Element 3’s domain.
- Negative keywords present: absence of explicit grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or direct Socratic/Paideia references in the accessible text. This reduces the completeness of a full classical curriculum as defined by the lexicon.
- Why this rating
- The school markets itself as classical and emphasizes a “rigorous classical curriculum” and character formation, but the accessible public content pages do not unambiguously enumerate the full traditional curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, etc.). Given the partial alignment with classical curricular elements, this category is BEST rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The publicly accessible East Tucson pages emphasize a supportive, community-oriented environment, smaller class sizes, and enrichment in arts/athletics. There is no explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, chanting, or the restated Scholé-based pedagogy in the text we can quote. The absence of explicit Socratic or restfully contemplative practices is notable in the accessible excerpts.
- The “pedagogy” language that would point to semiclassical methods (e.g., Socratic discussion, memorization, chant, or deliberate Scholé-based rest) is not clearly stated in the public-facing content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: none from the explicit pedagogical indicators (e.g., Socratic seminar, memory work, chant, scholé, restfulness) appear in the accessible East Tucson pages.
- Negative keywords present: there is no explicit statement of modern, constructivist, or purely experiential/project-based pedagogy either; but the absence of the explicit classical pedagogy indicators is the salient point here. The lexicon lists “Socratic dialogue” and “recitation/chanting” as positive signals for classical pedagogy; their absence in the public text leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating in this category given the rubric.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit evidence of classical pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, scholé, memory work, chanting, etc.) in the public materials, the category does not yet meet the criteria. The school’s messaging around a classical framework is present, but explicit pedagogy alignment is not evidenced in the accessible content. Therefore, Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school describes its teachers as dedicated to a supportive, safe environment and highlights partnership with families; the accessible pages emphasize the “East Tucson Team” and the idea that teachers know each scholar and partner with families to encourage success. This language aligns with the notion of teachers as models of virtue and mentors and the “living curriculum” concept found in the classical lexicon.
- The general tone emphasizes caring educators and a school culture built around teacher-student relationships, which can be read as embodying the “portrait of a teacher” and “faculty as living curriculum” elements found in the classical elements.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtuous educators/mentorship (implied through statements about dedicated teachers, safe environment, partnership with families), living curriculum (textually implied by “team” and “caring educators” language; the lexicon lists “virtue formation,” “mentorship,” “living curriculum,” and “portrait of a teacher” as positives).
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public text for this category (no “facilitators on the side” or non-classical teacher models in the accessible excerpts).
- Why this rating
- The public materials portray a faculty culture focused on virtue, mentorship, and close faculty-student relationships, aligning with Element 5’s classical indicators. Thus, Element 5 is CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is clear emphasis on partnership with parents and families; materials describe parents as partners in learning and note that families are a central part of the Leman East Tucson experience. The site highlights parent resources, staff engagement, and opportunities for families to participate (e.g., calendars, staff view, plan to visit, volunteer options, and parent-facing pages). This aligns with the classical emphasis on parental partnership and engagement beyond the classroom.
- The site quotes “Parents at Leman Academy are true partners in learning” and references open communication and family involvement. These signals map to the classical indicators for “partnership with families” and “parent formation/engagement.”
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, family involvement, open campus, parent visits. These are positive indicators for Element 6 in the classical lexicon.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the accessible content for this category.
- Why this rating
- The public-facing content strongly supports Element 6 as CLASSICAL due to explicit emphasis on parent partnership and family engagement as core to the school model. This aligns with the “parents as co-teachers” and “open campus” signals in the classical lexicon.

Aggregate assessment

- Count of categories by designation:
- CLASSICAL: Categories 2, 5, 6
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: Categories 1, 3
- NOT CLASSICAL: Element 4
- Aggregated ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (applicable if any category were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- If we were to push Element 1 and Element 3 toward CLASSICAL, the following concrete steps would help:
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Explicitly articulate theological grounding or liturgical/community practices (e.g., liturgical calendar, morning prayer, or chapel presence) and reference transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) as explicit, knowable realities integrated across disciplines.

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Provide explicit enumerations of the curriculum components that align with the classic Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Great Books approach, including any Latin/Greek language offerings, historical scope (Western civilization and primary sources), and direct references to Great Books and classical texts. Include a publicly visible map of core texts and authors (e.g., Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare) to anchor Great Books and cultural transmission.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly publish the pedagogical framework that includes Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation/chanting, Scholé-oriented practices, and opportunities for upper-school rhetoric and public speaking.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Provide a public portrait of the teacher as mentor and model of virtue; present formal teacher development in classical pedagogy and lived exemplars of the virtues the school aims to cultivate.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): While strong, further codify parent formation opportunities (book studies, parent clubs, liturgical learning resources) and provide structured, ongoing parent-teacher collaboration plans.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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